

Token Marketplace Monetization Strategy

Operating thesis: sell token access to consumers, let publishers monetize tools/agents/data, and keep platform margin through price bands, usage floors, and net-revenue share.

75-90%	30%+	\$5-60	0%
publisher payout range	minimum gross margin	publisher price band / 1M tokens	platform take on first \$10K GMV

1. Consumer Pricing

Consumer Tier	Price	Included	Overage	Best For
Sandbox	Free	100K/mo	-	Trial / testing
Developer	\$49/mo	3M	\$18 / 1M	Builders
Team	\$299/mo	30M	\$12 / 1M	Growing teams
Business	\$1,499/mo	200M	\$9 / 1M	Production
Enterprise	\$10K+ commit	Custom	\$5-8 / 1M	High volume

2. Token Pack Add-Ons

Token Pack	Price	Effective Rate
1M	\$25	\$25 / 1M
10M	\$199	\$19.90 / 1M
100M	\$1,499	\$14.99 / 1M
1B	Custom	\$5-8 / 1M

3. Publisher Price Bands

Publisher Listing	Suggested Price
Utility tools / simple APIs	\$2-6 / 1M
Specialized workflows	\$8-20 / 1M
Premium agents / proprietary data	\$25-60 / 1M
Regulated / verified enterprise	Custom + monthly minimum

4. Publisher Commission

Publisher Tier	Publisher	Platform
Standard	75%	25%
Verified	80%	20%
Enterprise / private	85%	15%
Strategic exclusive	90%	10% for 12 mo

Launch Incentive

0% platform take on each publisher's first \$10K GMV.
Then graduate to standard share. This seeds high-quality supply without weakening long-term margins.

Hard Pricing Rules

- 1. Minimum platform gross margin: **30%**.
- 2. Bill input + output + tool execution tokens.
- 3. Cached/reused tokens bill at **20% rate**.
- 4. Refund failed executions automatically.
- 5. Rank by usage, retention, latency, refund rate, and security score.

Unit Economics Example

Consumer pays **\$12 / 1M tokens**. Pass-through cost is **\$3**. Net marketplace revenue is **\$9**. Verified publisher earns **\$7.20**; platform keeps **\$1.80**.

Formula: Consumer price - pass-through AI/API cost - payment processing = net marketplace revenue.
Publisher share is paid from net revenue.

Benchmarks: token billing mirrors OpenAI/Anthropic API norms; take rate sits between enterprise marketplaces and app stores. Sources: openai.com, anthropic.com, microsoft.com, google.com, apple.com, shopify.dev.